

**Under-Secretary-General for Humanitarian Affairs and Emergency Relief
Coordinator, Tom Fletcher**

Statement on Venezuela

We are fully mobilised to support the people of Venezuela following the deadly and devastating earthquakes that hit the country yesterday.

I'm in constant contact with our team in Caracas, led by Humanitarian Coordinator Gianluca Rampolla, to ensure a swift and effective response. He has spoken this morning to the interim President and we are assessing urgently what is needed. Our team in Venezuela is working with the authorities to identify priorities.

OCHA is coordinating the rapid deployment of Urban Search and Rescue Teams from across the international community through the International Search and Rescue Advisory Group. I am surging a rapid response team to reinforce the OCHA team in country.

The solidarity and practical offers from the region and beyond are superb. The coming days will require a massive collective effort to support the Government-led response and help communities.

Even before these earthquakes, nearly 8 million people in Venezuela were in need of humanitarian support. This disaster risks deepening existing vulnerabilities.

Sustained international support for humanitarian organizations responding on the ground is essential and urgent.

Geneva, 25 June 2026